The Littlest Raindrop

A bedtime story for ages 3–7 · about 4 minutes to read aloud

High above the hills, in a soft grey cloud, lived a raindrop named Pip. Pip was the littlest raindrop in the whole cloud, and Pip had never been anywhere at all.

"Where do we go when we fall?" Pip asked the big raindrop next to her.

"Everywhere," said the big raindrop. "Just wait and see."

That night the cloud grew heavy, and one by one the raindrops let go. Pip held on as long as she could, and then, plip, she let go too.

Down, down, down she floated, past a sleepy owl, past the tops of the pine trees, until she landed with a tiny splash on a leaf.

She slid along the leaf and dropped into a little stream. The stream was full of raindrops, all chattering and tumbling and laughing.

"Where are we going?" Pip asked.

"To the river," they said. "Then to the lake. Then, who knows?"

The stream carried Pip under a bridge and past a fox having a drink. "Thank you for the water," said the fox, and Pip felt very proud.

At the lake, the water was calm and still. The moon looked down and made a silver path across it. Pip floated on her back and looked up at the stars.

In the morning, the sun came out and warmed the lake. Pip felt light, lighter than ever. Slowly, gently, she rose up into the sky, up past the trees, up past the owl,

all the way back to the soft grey cloud.

"Where did you go?" asked the big raindrop.

Pip smiled a raindrop smile. "Everywhere," she said. "And tomorrow, I'll go again."

And the littlest raindrop closed her eyes, safe and snug in the cloud, and dreamed of rivers.

The end.

For grown-ups: Little ones learn habits from what we do. If you'd like a gentle nudge to drink your own water through the day, Dropkin is a free iPhone water reminder. · Free story from Honest Little Apps · honestlittleapps.github.io/bedtime-stories